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into capital equipment and India must be able to make that.

When you look at it, many things need to come together to create the whole ecosystem. Now, we are speaking of

the supply side, but one must start thinking of demand as well.

The way I see it, this is becoming a national priority. We need ten more companies to join in this effort. We

don't speak very often of wanting competition, but the situation today is really about that. It is necessary to get the momentum going for the country. The government's thinking is very complete and holistic. The onus is, therefore, on companies to start doing what is necessary to align with this national agenda.



You have taken some interesting and big bets in the recent past. How much has the decision-making process changed?

For the first time I feel a certain Indianness getting exhibited in different aspects of our operations, including how we make decisions as leaders.

I studied here and in the US, plus I got to work there at [consulting major] McKinsey. A lot of that training revolves around making good decisions with data and analytics. Then, there is the role of intuition, and India is known for this higher form of intelligence. It's just a question of how you tap into it. I really think people are beginning to understand how you can get more in tune with intuition. It is something only the East gets as a concept.

Talking of taking those decisions, CG Power is a classic example

of a company that was mired in many issues. It went into what is called a Swiss auction. When we entered that process we had to publish our price and anybody else could bid at that price. But then nobody else came in with an offer! I was really worried to see that no one was even interested. But you must base your decision on something. I have observed that all good, strong Indian business leaders back their intuition and judgement. We did exactly that.



You run a set of diversified businesses. Where does financial services firm Cholamandalam fit in with all this?

We have always focused on developing the core strength of businesses. A company with the ability to continuously compound over long periods makes us extremely comfortable. In a sense, all of us are catalysts in this process.

Cholamandalam is the only business where there is evidence of that compounding taking place over 16 years. The others have had a shorter run. The good thing for us is that Cholamandalam is showing us that it can continue to compound at a high rate for a long period. **BT**

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